

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣3

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠5

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥5

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥8

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 4
♥ K 7 6 4
♦ 8 6 2
♣ A J 6

♠ K J 9

♥ A Q

♦ K Q J 9 5

♣ K 10 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 7 2

♥ J 9 3 2

♦ 10 4

♣ 7 3 2

♠ 10 6 3

♥ 10 8 5

♦ A 7 3

♣ Q 9 8 5

NORTH has 20 points, counting one extra for the fifth Diamond. Just right to open 2NT.

SOUTH has 6 points, just enough to bid 3NT. (20 + 6 = 26) (21 + 6 = 27)

West

Pass

North

2NT

East

Pass

South

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♣3

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 3
♥ K 10 6
♦ A 9 4
♣ 10 7 5 2

♠ 6
♥ Q J 7 4 2
♦ 6 3 2
♣ A 9 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9 2
♥ A 9 8
♦ Q 10 8
♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 7 5 4
♥ 5 3
♦ K J 7 5
♣ 8 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	Pass	1NT	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 5			

After WEST passes initially, EAST opens 1NT.

With 9 points, WEST has invitational strength, so he says 2NT.

EAST has a small problem - WEST's bid tells her to bid 3NT with 17 points, but to pass with 15 points. Her problem is that she has 16! Since it looks to her like a "good" 16 points she bids 3NT. If those 10's and 9's had been 4's and 3's she would have passed.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

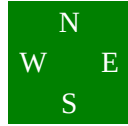
♠ 6 2
♥ J 9 6 5
♦ Q 8 5 4
♣ 9 6 5

♠ A 7

♥ A 8 4

♦ K 10 6

♣ K J 7 4 2



♠ J 10 8 5 4

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 9 3 2

♣ A 3

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ K Q 10

♦ A J 7

♣ Q 10 8

SOUTH has a great 1NT hand - 17 points and 4-3-3-3 shape.

NORTH has 16 points; he figures it is possible that SOUTH can make a slam, but only if she has a 17 point opener. So he bids 4NT, expecting SOUTH to bid 6NT if she has 17 points but to pass if she has fewer.

He figured right - SOUTH had 17 points so she bid 6NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1NT
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♥5			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ Q 9 6
♦ K Q 5 2
♣ K J 8

♠ J 6 5 2
♥ 10 8 7 2
♦ 10 9 7
♣ A 4



♠ K 8
♥ A K 5
♦ A 8
♣ Q 10 9 6 3 2

♠ Q 10 9 3
♥ J 4 3
♦ J 6 4 3
♣ 7 5

West

1NT

All Pass

6NT by West

Lead: ♥8

North

Pass

East

6NT

South

EAST definitely does NOT have a balanced hand.
She has two doubletons and a 6-card Club suit.

But she DOES have 18 points, (two extra for the fifth and sixth Clubs), and her 18 added to WEST's minimum of 15 is enough to bid 6NT.

Notice how easy this will be to play once that Club suit is established.